

Press Releases

Superior Environmental Solutions Acquires Captain Clean, Further Expanding Operations into the Midwest

May 20th, 2025

— Rapidly Growing SES Continues to Expand its Industrial and Environmental Services Nationwide with 65 Locations Across 14 States —

CEDAR RAPIDS, Iowa, May 20, 2025 /PRNewswire/ — Superior Environmental Solutions (“SES”), a leading provider of comprehensive, essential, and non-discretionary environmental and industrial services, and a portfolio company of Palladium Equity Partners, LLC, today announced the acquisition of Captain Clean. This strategic acquisition expands SES’s operational footprint and strengthens its market presence in Iowa and across the Midwest, enhancing its service capabilities and customer reach within the agriculture and food processing sector. The acquisition of Captain Clean marks SES’ ninth acquisition in the past nine years and its third during Palladium’s 20 month ownership.

Founded in 1969, Captain Clean delivers a suite of recurring, essential industrial services closely aligned with SES’s offerings, including water blasting and power washing, industrial vacuuming and pumping, ice blasting, and additional specialized solutions for a blue-chip customer base.

With a workforce of nearly 1,000 employees, SES operates from over 65 facilities across 14 states in the Midwest, Southern, and Western United States. The Company offers a full suite of environmental and industrial solutions, including hydro blasting, vacuum truck services, waste management, product destruction, tank cleaning, and a range of other technical services. SES serves a diverse base of more than 1,100 customer locations across key end markets such as agriculture, food processing, chemicals, metals, utilities, automotive, and refining.

John Stevens, Chief Executive Officer of SES, commented, “We are delighted to welcome Captain Clean and its entire team to the SES family of essential environmental and industrial service providers. For 56 years, Captain Clean has built a strong reputation for delivering high-quality industrial cleaning solutions throughout the Iowa and Nebraska —services that are highly complementary to our own. Their expertise and longstanding customer relationships will further strengthen our capabilities and enable us to expand our reach and service offerings across the Midwest. We look forward to working together to continue providing exceptional value to our customers.”

Robert, Carol, and Larry Lehman of Captain Clean stated, “We are thrilled to join forces with SES, one of the nation’s fastest growing and most highly respected environmental and industrial services companies. We look forward to working with the SES and their private equity partners and are confident this combination will best serve the interests of our valued employees and customers.”

Scott Kirschner, Principal at Palladium Equity Partners, commented, “We are proud to support SES in its acquisition of Captain Clean, which further expands SES’ presence in the Midwest and accelerates its growth as a national leader in environmental and industrial services.” Daniel Ilundain, President at Palladium Equity Partners, mentioned, “This transaction underscores Palladium’s commitment to partnering with exceptional management teams to drive long-term value and industry leadership.”

Financial terms of the transaction were not disclosed. Keating Muething & Klekamp PLL served as legal advisor to SES.

About Superior Environmental Solutions

Founded in 1999, Superior Environmental Solutions (SES) is a leading provider of mission-critical, non-discretionary, environmental and industrial services, including high-pressure water jetting, vacuum equipment services, waste management, product destruction, specialized tank cleaning and other technical services. For more information about SES, visit <http://www.sesinc.com>.

About Palladium Equity Partners, LLC

Palladium is a private equity firm with over \$3 billion of assets under management. The firm invests in the middle market, focusing on companies in the U.S. Hispanic market, founder and family-owned businesses, and those with accretive M&A opportunities. The partners of the firm have significant experience in the consumer, services, industrials, and healthcare sectors. Since its founding in 1997, Palladium has invested in more than 230 businesses, including 41 platforms and over 190 add-ons. For more information, visit www.palladiumequity.com.

Contacts:

Jeff Sweren, Chief Financial Officer
JSweren@sesinc.com
513-682-4275

Jeffrey Taufield / Todd Fogarty
jeffrey.taufield@kekstenc.com or todd.fogarty@kekstenc.com
212-521-4800

SOURCE Palladium Equity Partners and Superior Environmental Solutions

New York

1270 Ave. of the Americas
31st Floor
New York, NY, 10020

Connecticut

1 Station Place
Suite 501
Stamford, CT, 06902

Michigan

830 Cottageview Drive
Suite 1011
Traverse City, MI, 49684

Tel. 212.218.5150
Fax. 212.218.5155